26900209

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours) REGULAR EXAMINATION, October 2026
Fifth Semester
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCENG301 –
AN INTRODUCTION TO LITERARY CRITICISM
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme for Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. (b) Aphra Behn [K] / [CO1]
2. (d) Rejection of Literary tradition [U] / [CO1]
3. (a) Irving Babbitt [K] / [CO2]
4. (c) Apollonian and Dionysian [K] / [CO2]
5. (c) Part of an ongoing dialogue [U] / [CO2]
6. (c) Riti School [An] / [CO3]
7. (a) It gathered ideas from many earlier theorists in a clear and organized manner [U] / [CO3]
8. (b) Sañcāribhāvas / temporary emotions that support the main emotion [K] / [CO3]
9. (c) John Crowe Ransom [U] / [CO4]
10. (b) Context [K] / [CO4]

(1x10=10)

Part B - Short Answer
Answer any **6** questions. Each question carries **5** marks

(Note to Examiners: Except for questions 12 and 16, all other questions in Part B would require liberal valuation since there is limited reference to the related topics in the source text).

11. Ralph Waldo Emerson – American Romanticism – transcendentalism – philosophical movement emphasizes intuition, individual perception, inherent goodness of human beings and unity of all creations – his ideas of nature and self reliance influenced many. [U] / [CO1]

12. Naturally expresses falsehood. 2. Operates through imitation. 3. Combines many different roles instead of one. 4. Appeals to the lower parts of the soul as emotions and desires. 5. Promotes diversity and multiplicity instead of unity. [U] / [CO1]

13. Writers should follow nature, not simply by imitating ancient works, but by exploring human nature deeply within themselves - understanding human nature internally – connects with creativity – writers are free to create new models- not just imitate classics – highlights wits, imagination, and invention. [U] / [CO1]
14. Poetry uses language in a fundamentally different way from ordinary speech – disrupts the normal associations that word carry in everyday use – distinctive kind of language – cumulatively shaped by a long tradition of poets. [U] / [CO2]

15. Literary work as an autonomous and self-contained verbal structure insulated from the world of ordinary language – he drew a separation of emotive and referential uses of language. [U] / [CO2]
16. Sringara – Rati , Hasya – Hasya, Karuna – Soka, Raudra – Krodh, Vira – Uts, Bhayanaka – Krodh, Bibhatsa – Ghrina, Adbuta- Ashcharya, Santa - Nirveda. [K] / [CO3]

17. Alankara (embellishment) – main source of poetic beauty – it separated poetic language from ordinary language – Svabavokti (natural description) - if alankara was absolutely necessary for poetry, then svabhavokti could not be accepted as poetry because it referred to expression without embellishment – the relationship between embellishment and the thing embellished existed naturally in alankara - svabavokti was unembellished expression (Kuntaka) – poems containing only svabavokti without any figure of speech are also beautiful – opinions are divided – some critics rejected. In contrast, others accepted it in some forms. [U] / [CO3]

18. Austen combined artistic skill and moral seriousness – creatively developed literary tradition – Leavis accepted Dickens as a genius, but lacked deep moral seriousness. [A] / [CO4]

19. Close reading – detailed and careful study of a literary text – focuses on language, words, imagery, symbols, structure, form and patterns in the text – not outside factors – meaning is created through language. *(Since there is no exact discussion on tone in close reading in the fourth module, marks to be awarded to sensible attempts.)* [An] / [CO4]

(5 x 6 = 30)

Part C - Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. Supported French Revolution – cultural and revolutionary ideas are revolutionary – Blake – first major Romantic poet – mystical and myth based - criticized emerging urban and industrial society – highlighted social injustice and attacked dominance of rational thinking – Wordsworth – nature and spirit – simple language and rustic life - Coleridge – power of imagination – primary and secondary – suspension of disbelief - Shelley – imagination over reason – elevated poetry's importance – Keats – negative capability. [U] / [CO1]

21. Criticism is rigorous- precise and scientific – focus on the text itself not historical background, biography or moral content – poetry is ontologically unique – can't be reduced to prose or paraphrase – literature and criticism should be autonomous disciplines. [U] / [CO2]

22. Earliest Bharata – Natyasastra – Rasa theory – Bhamaha – Kavyalankara – alankarika – Dandin – Kavyadarsa – discussed poetic qualities necessary in literature – Udbhata – figurative language in poetry – Anandhavardhana – Dhvanyaloka – theory of dhvani – Abhinavagupta – renaissance man – Kuntaka – Vakroktijivita – Ksemendra – Aucityavicaracarca- importance of propriety in literature – Mahimabhatta – Vyaktiviveka – supported theory of anumana or inference – Bhoja – Sringaraprakasa – Mammata – Kavyaprakasa – Jagannatha – the emperor of poets – pandita raja – Rasagangadhara – last major theoretician. [An] / [CO3]
23. Marks to be awarded to sensible attempts. [An] / [CO4]

(15 x 2 = 30)